

5.5.1 Temporary speed limits

Difference

Replace the entire Section 5.5.1 with the following:

Temporary speed limits can be used to regulate the speed of traffic due to roadworks, temporary hazards, emergencies or special events. Authorisation from the relevant road infrastructure manager needs to be obtained prior to works commencing, normally during the planning stage (TMP phase). Details of the temporary speed limit, approximate length of the temporary speed zone (e.g. temporary speed limit of 60 km/h for 150 m) and associated roadwork signing is submitted with the TMP. If alternative means of traffic control are adequate, there is no need to implement additional temporary speed zones.

Temporary speed limits are implemented for workplace safety and traffic safety requirements to protect workers from oncoming or passing traffic and road users from hazards within the static work site. To meet specified safe workplace requirements, including the protection of traffic controllers, reduction in traffic speeds to either 80 km/h, 60 km/h or 40 km/h must be required.

If the specified temporary speed limit is lower for site workplace safety requirements than traffic safety requirements, the temporary speed limit for workplace safety requirements takes precedence (e.g. high level of hazard for workers on foot in a worksite with reduced visibility – the required temporary speed limit is 40km/h or less).

Temporary speed zone conditions and lengths are outlined in Table 5.5.

The primary objective of temporary speed zones is to ensure that all workers operating in and around the work zone are safe. The secondary objective is to ensure the application of temporary speed zones are safe and convenient for road users. Sufficient warning of changes in speed limit due to surface condition and work zone layouts need to be communicated to all road users.

Where a decision has been made to create a temporary speed limit, the following apply:

- The temporary speed limit should be self-enforcing or will be enforced.
- The temporary speed limit must be realistic and reflect the condition of the worksite in real time. This will reduce the risk of road users ignoring the speed limit.
- The temporary speed limit must be obvious to all road users.